

DM3A Grader

AI-Powered Mastery Grading for Mathematics Instructors

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This manual walks you through every feature of DM3A Grader step by step. Whether you are grading a single student or an entire class of 25, you will find everything you need here.

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SECTION 1

01

Welcome to DM3A Grader

DM3A Grader is an AI-powered grading tool built specifically for mathematics instructors at community colleges and universities. It reads student work -- handwritten or typed -- and returns a detailed mastery score on the P1-P4 scale in about 60 seconds.

What DM3A Grader does for you:

- Reads handwritten student work from photos, scans, or PDFs
- Scores every problem individually on the P1-P4 mastery scale
- Evaluates four dimensions: Conceptual Understanding, Problem Solving, Work Shown, and Accuracy
- Writes personalized feedback for each student
- Generates a downloadable PDF report you can share directly with your student
- Grades an entire class of 25 students in under 10 minutes using Blackboard Batch Mode

Supported courses:

Course	Support Level
Elementary Statistics	Fully Supported
Intermediate Algebra	Fully Supported
Precalculus	Fully Supported
Linear Algebra	Beta
Calculus I	Beta
Calculus II	Beta

Beta courses are fully functional -- review the scores before finalizing grades.

SECTION 2

02

Starting Your Free Trial

DM3A Grader offers a 7-day free trial. No credit card required. Here is how to get started:

- 1 Go to dm3agrader.com in any web browser.
- 2 Find the "Start Free Trial" form on the page.
- 3 Type your email address and click "Start Free Trial."
- 4 Check your email inbox. You will receive a message with your temporary password within a few minutes.
- 5 Your trial password looks like this: trial-abc4rf. Save it -- you will need it every time you sign in during your trial period.
- 6 The trial is valid for 7 days from the moment you request it.

TIP

Check your spam folder if you do not see the email within 5 minutes.

After the trial:

When your 7-day trial ends, contact support@dm3agrader.com to subscribe. The founding rate is \$9/month -- locked in for the life of your subscription.

SECTION 3

03

Signing In

Every time you use DM3A Grader, you will sign in with your password. Here is the process:

- 1 Go to dm3agrader.com.
- 2 Click "Sign In" in the top-right corner of the page.
- 3 You will see a login card with one field: "Access Password."
- 4 Type your password (trial password or permanent password).
- 5 Click the eye icon on the right side of the field to show or hide your password as you type.
- 6 Click "Enter DM3A Grader" or press Enter on your keyboard.
- 7 A window appears showing which courses are fully supported. Read it and click "I understand -- Start Grading."

Common sign-in issues:

Wrong password: You will see "Incorrect password." Double-check that you are copying the full password including the "trial-" part.

Expired trial: You will see "Trial password has expired." Email support@dm3agrader.com to renew.

Network error: You will see "Could not verify password." Check your internet connection and try again.

SECTION 4

04

Grading One Student

After signing in you arrive at the Setup screen. This is where you configure each grading session. Follow these steps to grade a single student:

- 1 Select your course from the Subject dropdown at the top.
- 2 Type the assignment name (e.g., "Quiz 3 -- Linear Systems"). This appears on the student report.
- 3 Optionally add Rubric Notes -- any special grading instructions specific to this assignment.
- 4 Upload your answer key PDF in the middle upload zone (strongly recommended).
- 5 Upload the student's work in the bottom zone. Accepted formats: JPEG, PNG, PDF, HEIC (iPhone), DOCX.
- 6 You can select multiple photos at once -- for example, 4 photos of notebook pages.
- 7 Click "Grade with DM3A" and wait. A spinning indicator and status messages will keep you informed.

File size guidance:

File size	What happens
Under 4 MB	Uploaded as-is. No action needed.
4 MB - 25 MB	Automatically compressed before grading. You will see a blue notice.
Over 100 MB	A warning appears. Click "Grade anyway" to proceed (may be slower).

TIP

For best results, upload a clear answer key. Without it, the AI relies only on its own math knowledge.

SECTION 5

05

Grading a Full Class (BB Batch Mode)

BB Batch Mode lets you grade an entire class in one session by uploading all Blackboard submission files at once. The app detects Blackboard filenames automatically and groups files by student.

Step 1: Download submissions from Blackboard

- 1 Log in to Blackboard and open the assignment.
- 2 Click "Assignment File Download" or "Download All Submissions."
- 3 Blackboard creates a ZIP file. Download it and unzip the folder.
- 4 You will see files with names like: HW5_mdecker_attempt_2026-03-15_IMG_2683.jpeg

Step 2: Upload all files to DM3A Grader

- 1 On the Setup screen, select your course and type the assignment name.
- 2 Upload your answer key in the middle zone.
- 3 Click the bottom zone and select ALL files from the unzipped folder at once.
- 4 The interface switches automatically to BB Batch Mode. The button changes to "Review Student Groups."
- 5 Click "Review Student Groups."

Step 3: Review and clean up student groups

- 1 You see one card per student, listing all their submitted files.
- 2 Remove any unwanted files using the X button next to each file.
- 3 If a student submitted the assignment form as the first photo, check "Skip first uploaded file (cover sheet)."

- 4 Optionally type "Problems to grade" (e.g., "even problems 2-44") so the AI knows exactly what to look for.
- 5 Click "Grade All [N] Student(s)." Grading takes about 6 minutes for a class of 22.

TIP

Grading runs in groups of 5 students at a time. The status message updates as each group completes.

SECTION 6

06

Understanding Your Results

When grading is complete, the Results screen appears. Here is what you will see:

Student tabs

Across the top of the screen, one tab per student shows their name and a colored mastery badge. Click any tab to switch to that student's results. Tabs show usernames until you load a roster.

Student card details

Overall mastery badge: The student's final score: P1, P2, P3, or P4.

P3/P4 Rate: The percentage of problems scored at mastery or approaching mastery (e.g., "73% -- 16 of 22 problems").

Four dimension scores: Conceptual Understanding, Problem Solving, Work Shown, and Accuracy -- each scored P1-P4.

Problem Breakdown table: Every graded problem listed with its tier score and the AI's reasoning.

Personalized Feedback: A 2-3 sentence note written by the AI for this specific student.

Instructor Note: Any flags or concerns the AI noticed.

Overriding a score

Every score -- overall, dimension, and per-problem -- has a dropdown menu you can use to change the AI's rating. Your overrides are applied immediately and reflected in any PDF you download.

Loading real student names

- 1 In Blackboard, go to Grade Center and download the roster as a spreadsheet (TSV format).
- 2 On the Results screen, click "Load Roster."
- 3 Select the TSV file. The app matches students by username and renames all tabs automatically.
- 4 A message confirms how many students were matched.

Class Summary

At the bottom of the results screen, a Class Summary card shows the count of P1, P2, P3, and P4 students and the overall class P3/P4 rate. Students with unprocessable files are excluded from this calculation.

SECTION 7

07

Downloading Reports

Individual student report

Click "Download Report" in the toolbar to download a PDF for the student currently displayed. The file downloads to your computer immediately.

The PDF report contains:

- Navy header with the course name and assignment name
- Student name and color-coded mastery badge
- P3/P4 rate percentage
- Four dimension scores
- Full problem breakdown with all scores and AI reasoning
- Personalized feedback paragraph
- Date and Dr. Minaya's attribution at the bottom

Filename format:

Reports are named automatically: LastName_FirstName_AssignmentName_P3.pdf

Download all reports (entire class)

Click "Download All Reports" to generate PDFs for every graded student and package them into a single ZIP file. For a class of 22 students, this takes about 15-30 seconds.

The ZIP file is named:

DM3A_Reports_AssignmentName_2026-06-05.zip

TIP

Students with HEIC or DOCX processing errors are excluded from the ZIP automatically.

SECTION 8

08

The P1-P4 Mastery Scale

DM3A Grader uses a four-level mastery scale instead of a traditional percentage. Here is what each level means:

P4 **Mastery**
90% and above -- Student demonstrates complete understanding

P3 **Approaching Mastery**
80-89% -- Strong understanding with minor gaps

P2 **Developing**
60-79% -- Partial understanding, needs reinforcement

P1 **Beginning**
Below 60% -- Foundational gaps need to be addressed

The four dimensions

Every student receives a score on four separate dimensions in addition to the overall badge:

Dimension	What it measures
Conceptual Understanding	Does the student understand the underlying math concepts, not just the steps?
Problem Solving	Does the student apply the correct strategy and method to reach a solution?
Work Shown	Does the student show enough work for the instructor to follow their reasoning?
Accuracy	Are the final answers and intermediate calculations correct?

SECTION 9

09

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need to install anything?

No. DM3A Grader runs entirely in your web browser. Nothing to download or install.

What browsers are supported?

Google Chrome and Safari work best. Firefox works but may have trouble displaying HEIC photos taken on iPhones.

Can students submit handwritten work?

Yes. Students can photograph their handwritten work with a phone and submit the photos. For best results, the photos should be taken in good lighting with the page flat and the camera steady.

What if a student submits a Word document?

DOCX files are automatically converted to PDF before grading. No action needed on your part.

What if a student submits an iPhone HEIC photo?

The server converts HEIC files automatically. If conversion fails, the student shows a gray HEIC warning badge. Ask that student to resubmit as JPEG or PDF.

Can I change a grade the AI gave?

Yes. Every score -- overall, per dimension, and per problem -- has a dropdown override. Your changes are reflected in all downloaded PDFs.

How accurate is the AI grading?

For Fully Supported courses (Elementary Statistics, Intermediate Algebra, Precalculus), accuracy is high. For Beta courses, the AI performs well but you should review scores before finalizing. Always treat AI scores as a strong first draft.

Is my student data stored anywhere?

Student work is sent to the AI for grading and is not permanently stored. Contact support@dm3agrader.com for detailed data handling information.

Can I use this for courses not on the list?

Not yet. Contact support@dm3agrader.com if you would like your course considered for the next validation round.

How do I get help?

Click the "? Help" button inside the app at any time. For additional support, email support@dm3agrader.com.

Thank you for using DM3A Grader. We built this tool for instructors who care deeply about their students and deserve better support.

Questions or feedback: support@dm3agrader.com | dm3agrader.com